



```
carlin@nyc:~$ ./internship-review
```

Beyond the Code

What NYC and the AI Era Taught Me

Carlin Hou

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Universal Processing · Summer 2026

\$ whoami



name	Carlin Hou
role	Software Engineering Intern
team	Universal Processing
current	New York City

// background

**My background
combines business and
information systems.**

I connect technical decisions with users,
operations, and company goals.

Taiwan → New York City: The environment changed quickly; my willingness to adapt did not.

My Best Work Starts Early

// why the early start

Morning energy goes to the work that needs the clearest thinking.

I'm usually in before 8:30—and often first at the office.

BEFORE 08:30	<code>sync()</code>	Taiwan handoff Email · chat · Jira · daily plan
MORNING	<code>focus()</code>	Deep work Demos · docs · architecture · code
LUNCH	<code>reset()</code>	Recharge Weekend meal prep · short nap
AFTERNOON	<code>verify()</code>	Close the loop QA · docs · code review · plan check

— Align early. Build deeply. Verify before leaving.

The Work Started Before the Code

```
// product loop
```

```
context |> requirements |> jira |> prototype |> test |> feedback |> iterate
```

Add Jira workflow screenshot

/media/jira-workflow.png

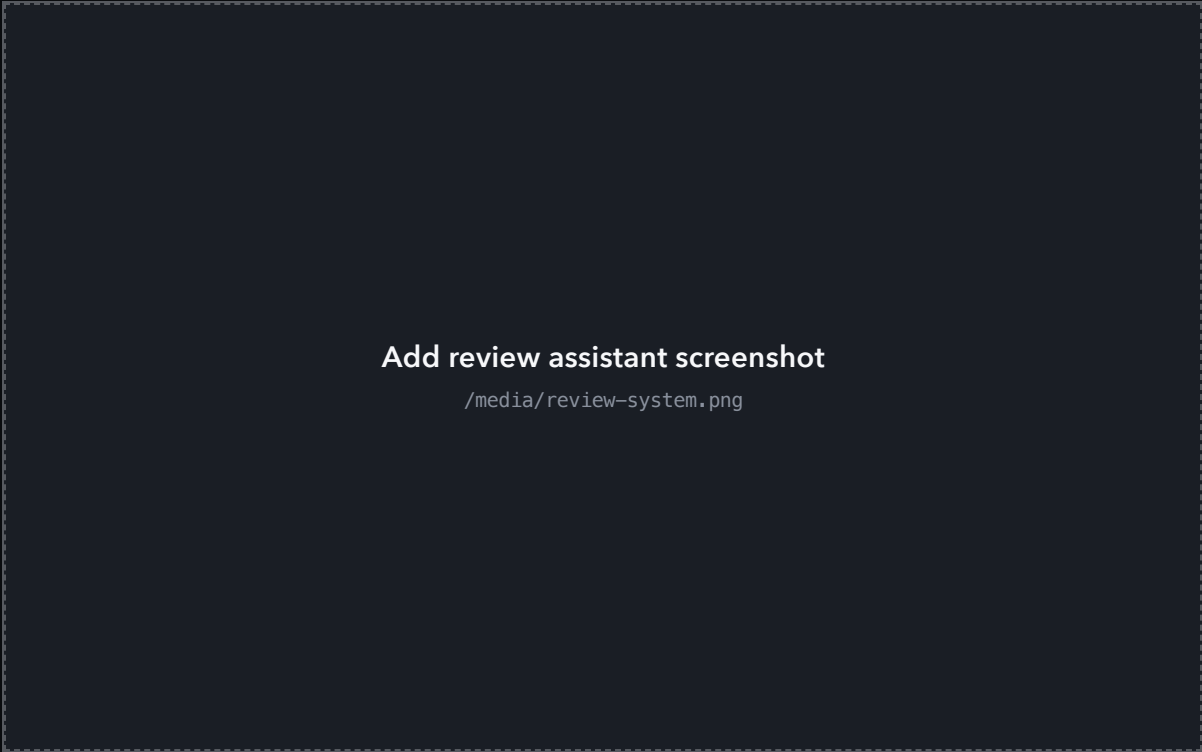
— **Development starts with shared understanding.**

Three Projects. Three Different Problems.

- | | | |
|----------|---|--|
| 01 | <code>generate()</code>
AI Review Assistant | Content generation with human control. |
| 02 | <code>retrieve()</code>
Internal Support Chatbot | Trusted retrieval and grounded answers. |
| 03 / MVP | <code>coordinate()</code>
Salon Booking Assistant | Business-rule reasoning and resource coordination. |
-

— **One technology. Three different product responsibilities.**

Human Review Stays in the Reply Workflow



// designed approval workflow

retrieve()



generate()



review()



edit()



publish()



record()

CONTRIBUTION OAuth · review retrieval · filters · AI/edit history

NEXT Approval validation · multi-client workflow

Useful automation increases speed without removing accountability.

The Chatbot Searches Before It Answers

// grounded answer + evaluation pipeline

question

retrieve(evidence)

generate(grounded_answer)

evaluate()

↓

↓

↓

Semantic retrieval	Keyword retrieval
Quality + latency evaluation	Chat + voice workflows
Speech-to-text · explored	Text-to-speech · explored

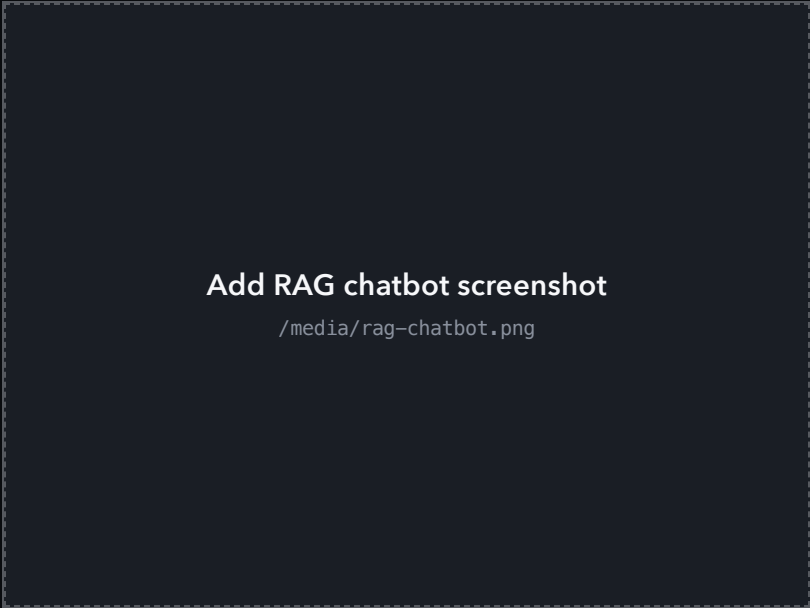
CONTRIBUTION

Knowledge integration · hybrid retrieval · evaluation

NEXT

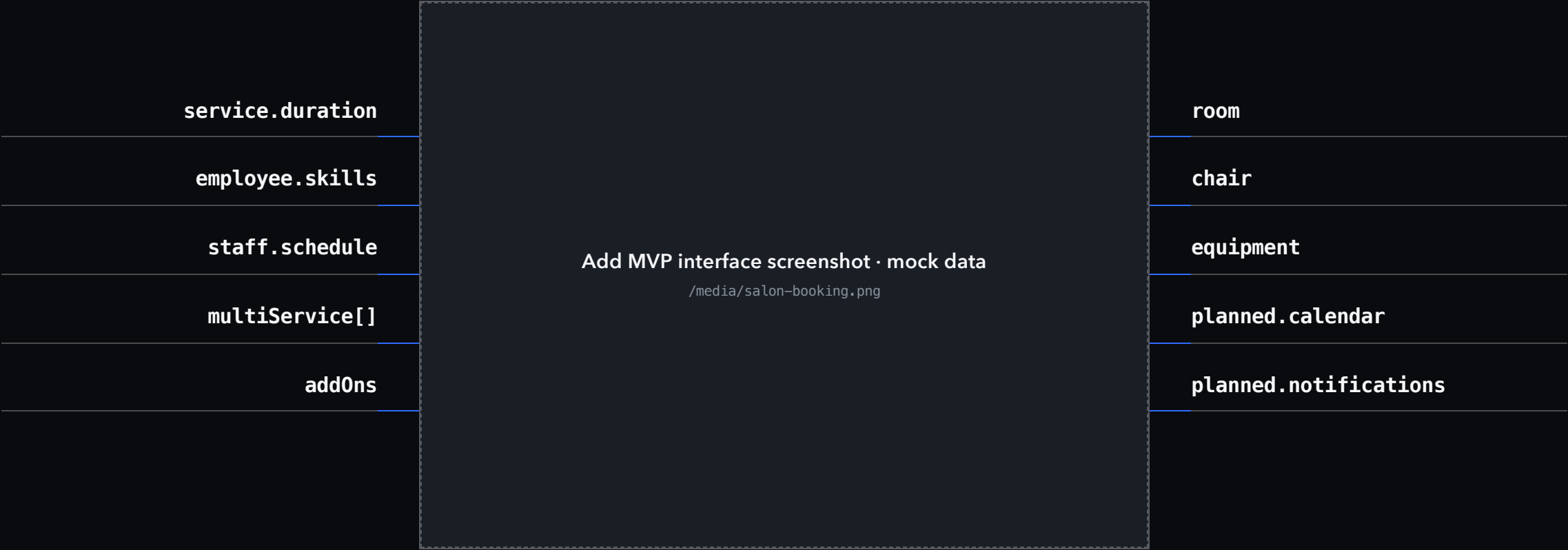
Tune retrieval with internal-user feedback

The best technical idea is not always the most useful product decision.



The Salon MVP Starts With Business Rules

CONTRIBUTION PRD · data model · matching rules · system constraints



— When implementation becomes faster, unclear requirements become more expensive.

How My Use of AI Changed

v1.0

College

AI as a search tool

Samples + Stack Overflow.

v2.0

Internship in Taiwan

AI as a coding partner

Specific tasks. Limited context.

v3.0

New York City

AI inside a complete
product process

Specs. Steps. Review. Feedback.

— The developer's role is shifting from producing more code to making better decisions.

The Bottleneck Moved.

BEFORE	IN THE AI ERA
Writing code	Defining the right problem
Implementation speed	Clear requirements
Technical execution	Human judgment
Feature delivery	Product alignment
Individual output	Shared knowledge

— Speed creates value only when the team shares a clear destination.

From military service in Taiwan
to building AI products in New York.

**Still learning.
Still building.
Still halfway.**

With thanks to Taipei City, Universal Processing, the engineers, coworkers, and
interns who shaped this summer.

Thank you.

